Merge SalesInvoice with Customer on CustomerID

20,914 rows of SalesInvoice → left outer merge → **20,914** rows after the merge

CustomerID in Customer: each key appears once
220 rows, 220 different keys

One invoice, SI-2026-014255, after the merge

InvoiceNumber	CustomerName
SI-2026-014255	Bryant, Day and Rivera

Count unchanged: merge safe

Merge SalesInvoice with Shipment on SalesOrderID

20,914 rows of SalesInvoice → left outer merge → **41,408** rows after the merge **+20,494** rows

SalesOrderID in Shipment: the key repeats in the second table
9,707 rows for 5,529 orders; 3,186 orders have several

One invoice, SI-2026-014255, after the merge

InvoiceNumber	ShipmentDate
SI-2026-014255	2026-01-31
SI-2026-014255	2026-02-05

Count grew: the key repeats

Both merges are left outer merges, so no invoice is dropped. The row count after loading is the test: compare it with the 20,914 invoices. Merging on a key that repeats in the second table gives the invoice one row for each match, here one for each shipment of its order, and every total on the invoice then counts twice or more. Amber cells: the invoice number repeated by the merge.